Crown Lengthening

Category: Periodontal / Gum Care Suggested URL: `/dental-care/periodontal-gum-care/crown-lengthening`

Creating the Right Foundation for a Dental Crown

Sometimes, a tooth may be too short or too damaged above the gum line for a dental crown or filling to be placed properly. In other cases, excess gum tissue covers more of the tooth than desired, affecting its appearance.

Crown lengthening is a dental procedure that exposes more of the natural tooth by reshaping the gum tissue and, when necessary, the supporting bone. It can help create enough accessible tooth structure for a restoration or improve the balance between the teeth and gums.

The procedure is planned according to the tooth's condition, the surrounding tissues and the final restorative or cosmetic goal.

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Two Reasons Crown Lengthening May Be Recommended

Crown lengthening is not only a cosmetic procedure. It may also be needed to help restore a damaged tooth.

Restorative crown lengthening

When decay, a fracture or an existing restoration extends close to the gum line, crown lengthening may expose more tooth structure so the dentist can plan a suitable restoration.

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Aesthetic crown lengthening

When excess gum tissue makes the teeth appear short, reshaping the gum line may create a more balanced appearance. Bone reshaping may be needed in some cases, depending on the underlying anatomy.

Not everyone with short-looking teeth or a gummy smile needs crown lengthening. A dental examination helps identify whether the cause is excess gum tissue, tooth position, lip movement or another factor.

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What Happens During the Procedure?

The treatment depends on how much tooth structure needs to be exposed and whether the supporting bone must also be reshaped.

1. **Planning the new gum line**
   The dentist examines the tooth, gums and bite. Dental X-rays may be used to assess the root and surrounding bone before treatment.

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2. **Reshaping the gum tissue**
   Local anaesthesia is used, and the gum tissue is carefully adjusted to expose more of the tooth.

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3. **Adjusting the supporting bone, if needed**
   In some cases, a small amount of bone must be reshaped to establish an appropriate relationship between the gum, bone and tooth.

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4. **Healing and restorative planning**
   The treated area is allowed to heal. If crown lengthening was performed to prepare a tooth for a crown, the dentist determines when the final restoration can be completed.

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How Can Crown Lengthening Help?

Depending on the reason for treatment, crown lengthening may help to:

- Expose more natural tooth structure for a filling or crown.

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- Improve access to damaged areas that extend close to the gum line.

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- Create a more balanced gum line in suitable cosmetic cases.

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- Support restorative planning when the tooth needs additional accessible structure for treatment.

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The procedure does not make the root itself longer. The amount of tooth exposed, the final appearance and the suitability of a restoration depend on the tooth's anatomy and supporting tissues.

Recovery and the Final Result

Crown lengthening involves gum surgery, so healing and follow-up are important parts of treatment.

During recovery, you may notice temporary tenderness, swelling or sensitivity. Your dentist will explain how to care for the surgical area and when to resume normal cleaning around it.

- Eat soft foods initially if advised, and avoid irritating the treated area.

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- Follow your prescribed medication and oral-hygiene instructions.

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- Avoid disturbing any stitches or dressing.

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- Attend follow-up appointments to monitor healing.

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- Wait for your dentist's advice before proceeding with a final crown or other restoration.

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Healing time varies. In restorative cases, the dentist may allow additional time for the gum line to stabilise before making the final restoration, particularly when the visible front teeth are involved.

Before and After: Exposing More of the Tooth

Before

Limited visible tooth structure or excess gum coverage may affect restorative treatment or appearance.

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After healing

More tooth structure may be visible, creating access for restoration or a changed gum-line appearance.

These images are illustrative, not actual patient results. Use genuine, consented clinical photographs for the Jerush website if showing real outcomes.

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. Is crown lengthening only for cosmetic purposes?

No. It can be performed to expose more tooth structure for restorative treatment or to improve the appearance of the gum line in selected cases.

2. Is crown lengthening painful?

Local anaesthesia is used during the procedure. Some discomfort, swelling or sensitivity can occur afterwards, and your dentist can advise you on appropriate pain relief.

3. Does crown lengthening always involve removing bone?

No. Some cases require only gum reshaping, while others need bone contouring. The approach depends on the tooth's anatomy and treatment goal.

4. Will my teeth look longer after treatment?

The treated teeth may appear longer because more of their natural structure is exposed. The amount of change depends on the original gum line and the procedure performed.

5. How long does crown lengthening take to heal?

Initial healing may take a few weeks, but complete tissue maturation can take longer. Your dentist will decide when the area is ready for the next stage of treatment.

6. Will I need a dental crown afterwards?

Not always. A crown may be recommended when the tooth needs protection or reconstruction, but cosmetic crown lengthening may not require one.

7. Are there any risks?

Possible risks include sensitivity, changes in gum appearance, uneven gum contours and exposure of root surfaces. Removing too much supporting bone may affect tooth stability, so careful planning is important.

Plan Your Gum and Restorative Treatment at Jerush

Whether the goal is to restore a damaged tooth or improve the balance of your smile, crown lengthening should be planned around your dental health and long-term needs.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, a dental assessment can help determine whether crown lengthening is suitable and whether gum reshaping alone or additional bone contouring may be required.

Have a tooth that is difficult to restore or concerns about excess gum coverage? Arrange a consultation to explore your treatment options.

SEO recommendations

- SEO title: Crown Lengthening Treatment | Periodontal Care at Jerush
- Meta description: Discover how crown lengthening can expose more tooth structure for dental restorations or improve the gum line. Learn about treatment, healing and aftercare at Jerush.
- Primary keyword: Crown lengthening
- Related keywords: Crown lengthening surgery, gum reshaping, restorative crown lengthening, gummy smile treatment, periodontal surgery
- Suggested image alt text: `Crown lengthening procedure to expose more natural tooth structure by reshaping gum tissue`